

BHAVESH SHASHIKANT GAWADE

Product Manager | AI-First Product Strategy | Platform & Fintech Product Leadership | 16+ Years
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product leader with 16 years of experience owning end-to-end strategy, roadmap, and business outcomes for enterprise fintech, digital banking, and low-code platform products. Built and scaled Blaze Studio, an enterprise low-code platform for cloud-native payment applications, from roadmap definition through adoption and go-to-market, driving a sustained 30% uplift in engineering throughput and 25% platform adoption growth. Deep AI-first product expertise: co-defined 10+ GenAI/LLM use cases embedded into core platform offerings, backed by a formal postgraduate qualification in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning. Strong technical fluency in API-first architecture, microservices, and core banking systems, combined with a track record of aligning 10+ senior stakeholders and 20+ member cross-functional teams around OKR-driven roadmaps. Known for converting ambiguous enterprise requirements into scalable, revenue-impacting products for banking clients globally.

KEY SKILLS

Product Strategy & Vision • Product Lifecycle Ownership • AI / GenAI Product Strategy • Platform Ownership & Roadmap Leadership • OKR & KPI Definition • Go-to-Market Strategy • API-First & Microservices Architecture • Low-Code / No-Code Platforms • Solution Architecture & Design • Product Implementation & Customization • Production Go-Live Management • Requirement Gathering & Gap Analysis • Business Requirements Analysis • MVP Planning & Prioritization • User Story Authoring & Backlog Grooming • Wireframing & UX Collaboration • Sprint Planning & Release Management • SDLC & Delivery Governance • Agile Product Management • Data-Driven Decision Making • Customer Journey Mapping • Competitive Analysis • Digital Banking & Payments Solutions • Executive & Client Stakeholder Management • Cross-Functional Team Building & Leadership • Incident & Escalation Management • Customer Relationship Management • Customer Value Creation

APPLICATIONS HANDLED

Blaze Studio (Low Code Platform), Debit Card Management System, Corporate Customer Onboarding, Supply Chain Finance, Oracle Banking Digital Experience, Flexcube Direct Banking

SELECTED IMPACT

- Scaled an enterprise low-code platform (Blaze Studio) to 25% adoption growth while cutting engineering effort by 60% and overall delivery effort by 40%.
- Co-defined 10+ GenAI/LLM product use cases, backed by a formal MS in AI & Machine Learning, a rare combination of AI depth and banking-platform ownership.
- Led product delivery for banking platforms serving Yes Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, Vietcombank, and Federal Bank.
- Directed OKR-driven roadmaps across 20+ member cross-functional teams spanning engineering, UX, and AI Center of Excellence.

TECHNICAL ACUMEN

Technical fluency enabling architecture reviews, solution design, and engineering conversations

Microservices Architecture (Orchestration & Choreography) • Domain-Driven Design • API-First & Headless Architecture • BPM & Workflow Orchestration (Camunda, AWS Step Functions) • Cloud & Containerized Deployment (AWS, EKS, Docker) • CI/CD Pipeline Design (SonarQube, Terraform, Ansible) • Automation Testing (Selenium, Appium, Rest Assured, JMeter, Gatling) • Database Design & Optimization (Oracle, PostgreSQL, Redis) • Application Monitoring & Observability (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack) • REST & GraphQL API Design • Java-Based Enterprise Application Development • Core Banking & Payments Systems Integration

WORK EXPERIENCE

Assistant Product Manager | Financial Software & Systems (FSS), Mumbai | Mar 2023 – Present

Functioning as product lead for Blaze Studio, FSS's flagship enterprise low-code platform

Blaze Studio: Enterprise Low-Code Platform

- Own product strategy and roadmap for Blaze Studio, an enterprise low-code platform enabling rapid development of cloud-native payment applications through visual modelling and automated code generation, driving a sustained 30% uplift in engineering throughput.
- Define platform capabilities across UI development, domain-driven modelling, workflow orchestration, microservice development, code generation, deployment, and testing, powered by reusable enterprise services (Workflow, Rule Engine, Validation, Notification, Reporting, IAM, Security, Logging, Audit, Cache, Pub/Sub, Integrator), driving 25% platform adoption growth.
- Partner with engineering and solution architects to standardize microservice templates and automate backend/frontend code generation and deployment, cutting manual coding effort by 60% and overall engineering effort by 40%.
- Lead design of developer-centric, drag-and-drop visual application experiences, enabling UI creation up to 5x faster and compressing development cycles by 35% by eliminating requirement ambiguity.
- Co-define 10+ AI/GenAI and LLM use cases, including LLM-assisted application development, intelligent code generation, workflow recommendations, and automated domain modelling, to embed intelligent automation into core platform offerings.
- Optimize user story authoring workflows across 100+ stories, reducing rework by 20% and ensuring on-time sprint delivery.
- Drive roadmap transparency and delivery timelines through structured cross-functional alignment forums with 10+ senior leaders, partnering with DevOps and platform engineering to advance standardized templates and reusable assets, accelerating delivery by 25%.
- Reprioritize roadmap using KPI data and competitive analysis while owning the end-to-end product lifecycle (customer discovery, wireframing, backlog prioritization, sprint planning, release planning), amplifying feature adoption by 30% for banking clients requiring enterprise scale, security, compliance, and high-throughput payment workloads.

DCMS: Debit Card Management System

- Own product revisions for DCMS, translating bank RFP documents into gap analyses against existing platform capabilities.
- Author detailed user stories for new features and track delivery, providing management-level reporting on feature status and timelines.
- Engage directly with customers to capture new requirements and support UAT, guiding clients through functionality and validation.
- Facilitate sprint walkthroughs with development and QA teams, driving requirement understanding from a functional and semi-technical perspective.
- Guide database structure design and author reporting queries, enabling downstream reporting pipelines and business reports.

Senior Product Manager | i-Exceed Technology Solutions, Mumbai | Apr 2021 – Mar 2023

Growth: Product Manager (Apr 2021) → Senior Product Manager (Oct 2022) | Product lead for the Corporate Onboarding suite

- Own and execute the product roadmap for Corporate Onboarding, aligning 10+ stakeholders (sales, presales, customers, partners), cutting time-to-market by 30% through agile prioritization.
- Lead MVP planning for 10+ roadmap items using OKR frameworks, lifting sprint velocity by 30% across a 20+ member cross-functional team.
- Author and refine 200+ user stories with 100% clarity scores, cutting requirement-related defects by 25% and accelerating delivery cycles.
- Design 50+ low-fidelity wireframes through iterative UX collaboration, reducing rework by 20% and improving design-to-development handoff.

- Deliver seamless ERP connectivity for corporate banking clients, cutting transaction processing time by 40% and transaction failures by 15%.
- Reduce customer onboarding friction by 30%, improving adoption across 50+ corporate clients processing bulk salary payments daily.

Executive Project Manager | Intellect Design Arena Limited, Mumbai | Jul 2019 – Apr 2021

Product management & solutions leadership across Supply Chain Finance (PO, Receivables, Payables, Dealer/Distributor Finance) for global banking clients

- Drove root-cause analysis and resolution of bank-reported issues across Supply Chain Finance modules (PO Finance, Receivables Finance, Payables Finance, and Dealer/Distributor Finance), cutting average resolution cycles by 40% for Vietcombank and Federal Bank.
- Customized SCF product configuration to bank-specific requirements: PO validation & staged financing rules, receivables appropriation & reconciliation logic, payables discount & interest computation, and dealer onboarding & delinquency monitoring policies.
- Conducted on-site bank visits for critical issue resolution, requirement clarification, and go-live support, translating business requirements into scalable solution designs with Business Analysts and engineering teams.
- Prioritized SCF defects and enhancement requests by business criticality and bank operational impact, aligning fix sequencing with stakeholder priorities and delivery timelines.
- Coordinated UAT and testing cycles with banks' test teams, including test case review, defect triage, and sign-off, sustaining 95%+ client satisfaction across Supply Chain Finance go-lives.

Senior Principal Consultant | Oracle Financial Services Software Ltd, Mumbai | Mar 2011 – Jul 2019

Growth: Associate Consultant (2011) → Consultant (2012) → Senior Consultant (2016) → Principal Consultant (2016) → Senior Principal Consultant (2019) | Delivery & solution leadership across enterprise banking clients

- Customized Flexcube Digital Banking (Internet and Mobile Banking) for leading Indian and overseas banks, translating business requirements into scalable, production-ready customizations.
- Owned Internet and Mobile Banking customization for one of India's largest private sector banks over 3 years, partnering with customers and BAs on functional requirement analysis and effort estimation.
- Directed development execution with delivery teams, driving enhancement delivery, UAT support, and post-production support for banking clients.
- Implemented Oracle Banking Digital Experience (OBDX) for Indian and international banks, customizing the product to bank-specific requirements and delivering through UAT cycles.
- Supported OBDX customizations through go-live, ensuring stable production transitions for banking clients across geographies.

Team Member | IDBI Intech, Mumbai | Jun 2009 – Mar 2011

- Contributed to core banking implementation projects; recognized with the Reorganization Award (Mar 2011) for process improvement during internship.

EDUCATION

- MS in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning, Scaler in collaboration with Woolf University (2025)
- Master of Computer Applications (MCA), University of Mumbai (2009)
- Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, University of Mumbai (2006)

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Ideathon Winner, Payment Fraud Detection Concept, FSS (Jan 2025)
- Team of the Quarter Award, FSS (Jun 2024)
- Gem Award, Intellect Design Arena (Jun 2020)
- i-Appreciate Award, Oracle Financial Services Software (Feb 2013)
- Reorganization Award, IDBI Intech (Mar 2011)